

EUROPEAN HUNTING GUNS

Hunting guns were often built to popular regional styles that were in fashion at the time. Specific types of firing mechanism were preferred from place to place. The snaphance lock (see p.38), for instance, was preferred in Scotland and the wheel-lock (see pp.26–27) in German lands and in Italy. Hunting guns were often decorated with engraved and chiseled metalwork and inlaid stocks, to demonstrate the taste and wealth of their owner. In some regions of Europe where large game was hunted, hunters preferred rifles over smoothbore shotguns. Rifles had greater power and accuracy and were more capable of killing large animals.

